How Bees Make Honey

Name: _____Date: _____

INSTRUCTIONS: Read the passage carefully. Then circle the best answer for questions 1 to 4 and write full-sentence answers for questions 5 to 7.

Honey starts as nectar, a sweet liquid that flowers make to attract insects. A worker bee lands on a flower and sucks up the nectar with a long, tube-shaped tongue. She stores it in a special pouch called a honey stomach, which is separate from the stomach she uses for food. One bee may visit hundreds of flowers before her honey stomach is full.

Back at the hive, the forager passes the nectar, mouth to mouth, to a house bee. The house bee chews the nectar for about half an hour. Chemicals in her body break the sugars into simpler ones that will not spoil. Then she spreads the nectar in the thin wax cells of the honeycomb.

Fresh nectar is mostly water. If it stayed that way, it would go bad. So the bees fan their wings over the open cells, day and night, until most of the water has dried away and the liquid is thick and sticky. Now it is honey. The bees seal each cell with a cap of wax, and the honey stays good for years.

Bees do all this work to feed themselves. A hive needs honey to survive the winter, when there are no flowers. To make just one pound of honey, the bees of a hive may visit about two million flowers and fly a total of about 55,000 miles.

CIRCLE THE BEST ANSWER

1. What is nectar?

a) A kind of wax b) A sweet liquid made by flowers c) A type of bee d) Honey that has dried out

2. What does the house bee do with the nectar first?

a) Seals it with wax b) Drinks it c) Chews it for about half an hour d) Carries it to a flower

3. Why do the bees fan their wings over the cells?

a) To keep the hive cool b) To dry the water out of the nectar

c) To call the other bees d) To make the wax soft

4. In this passage, a "forager" is a bee that

a) guards the hive b) goes out to collect nectar c) is still a baby d) makes wax

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WRITE YOUR ANSWER IN FULL SENTENCES

5. Why does honey not go bad?

_____

_____

_____

6. Why do bees make honey?

_____

_____

_____

7. Number these steps in the order they happen: fan the cells, seal the cell with wax, collect nectar from flowers, chew the nectar.

_____

_____

_____

DRAW THE FOUR STEPS AS A COMIC STRIP

1. Collect nectar	2. Chew and spread	3. Fan the cells	4. Seal with wax

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ANSWER KEY: How Bees Make Honey

CIRCLE THE BEST ANSWER

1. A sweet liquid made by flowers
2. Chews it for about half an hour
3. To dry the water out of the nectar
4. goes out to collect nectar

WRITE YOUR ANSWER IN FULL SENTENCES

5. The house bee changes the sugars so they will not spoil, the bees fan out most of the water, and the cell is sealed with wax.
6. To feed themselves. The hive needs honey to survive the winter, when there are no flowers to visit.
7. Collect nectar from flowers (1), chew the nectar (2), fan the cells (3), seal the cell with wax (4).

DRAW THE FOUR STEPS AS A COMIC STRIP

Drawings are open-ended; check the order matches the text.

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